Safety Harness Inspection Checklist (29 CFR 1910.140)

For the inspection before initial use in each workshift, plus anchorage, rigging and rescue checks on site.

OSHA 29 CFR 1910.140

DATE	SHIFT
INSPECTOR	AREA / EQUIPMENT ID

Before you start

1. Mark every item OK, Defect or N/A.
2. Remove any defective component from service (1910.140(c)(18)). Equipment subjected to impact loading stays out of use until a competent person clears it (1910.140(c)(17)).
3. The manufacturer's instructions and your site rules may add checks to this list.

Legal basis: 29 CFR 1910.140: Personal fall protection systems (Part 1910 Subpart I, Personal Protective Equipment) Source: eCFR, Title 29, https://www.ecfr.gov/current/title-29/section-1910.140 (text as of 2026-11-09)

Online version and sources: https://safetyindex.blog/us/standards/1910-140-personal-fall-protection-systems

SECTION A | Harness, lanyards and lifelines

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
1	Webbing, stitching and rope condition Ref. 1910.140(c)(18)	No mildew, wear, damage or other deterioration on any strap, stitch line or rope	☐	☐	☐	
2	Impact loading Ref. 1910.140(c)(17)	Not subjected to impact loading, or a competent person has inspected it and found it undamaged and safe	☐	☐	☐	
3	Harness type Ref. 1910.140(d)(3)	Full body harness in use; no body belt used as part of a personal fall arrest system	☐	☐	☐	
4	Knots in lanyards or vertical lifelines Ref. 1910.140(c)(6)	Every knot inspected by a competent or qualified person before the line is used	☐	☐	☐	
5	Lifeline material Ref. 1910.140(c)(15)	No natural fiber rope used as a lifeline	☐	☐	☐	
6	Polypropylene rope Ref. 1910.140(c)(15)	Any polypropylene rope contains a UV light inhibitor	☐	☐	☐	
7	Protection from damage Ref. 1910.140(c)(20)	Lines and harness kept clear of anything that could cut, abrade or melt them	☐	☐	☐	
8	Use limited to fall protection Ref. 1910.140(c)(16)	Equipment not used to hoist tools or materials	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION B | Connectors: D-rings, snaphooks and carabiners

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
9	Finish and edges Ref. 1910.140(c)(2)	Corrosion-resistant finish; smooth surfaces and edges with nothing that could damage connected parts	☐	☐	☐	
10	Locking gates Ref. 1910.140(c)(9)	Snaphooks and carabiners lock automatically and need two separate, consecutive movements to open	☐	☐	☐	

General guidance only, not legal advice. Check the current regulation and your employer's procedures.

SECTION B | Connectors: D-rings, snaphooks and carabiners

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
11	Rated strength Ref. 1910.140(c)(7)	D-rings, snaphooks and carabiners rated to sustain at least 5,000 pounds (22.2 kN) tensile load	☐	☐	☐	
12	Clip to webbing or rope Ref. 1910.140(c)(10)(i)	Not clipped directly to webbing, rope or wire rope, or the connector is designed for that	☐	☐	☐	
13	Hook to hook Ref. 1910.140(c)(10)(ii)	No snaphook or carabiner clipped to another, unless built for it	☐	☐	☐	
14	Shared D-ring Ref. 1910.140(c)(10)(iii)	No connector added to a D-ring already holding another connector, unless designed for it	☐	☐	☐	
15	Horizontal lifeline connection Ref. 1910.140(c)(10)(iv)	Only connectors designed for horizontal lifelines are attached to one	☐	☐	☐	
16	Shape compatibility Ref. 1910.140(c)(10)(v)	Connected object cannot press the gate open and let the parts separate	☐	☐	☐	
17	Compatibility with straps and lines Ref. 1910.140(c)(19)	Ropes, belts, lanyards and harness match every connector used with them	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION C | Anchorages and lifelines

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
18	Independent anchorage Ref. 1910.140(c)(12)	Fall protection anchorage separate from any anchorage that suspends workers or platforms	☐	☐	☐	
19	Powered industrial truck platform Ref. 1910.140(c)(12)	Anchorage on an overhead member of the platform, above and near its center	☐	☐	☐	
20	Anchorage rating Ref. 1910.140(c)(13)(i)	Anchorage supports at least 5,000 pounds (22.2 kN) for each employee attached	☐	☐	☐	
21	Engineered anchorage (if not rated per employee) Ref. 1910.140(c)(13)(ii)	Designed, installed and used under a qualified person's supervision, as part of a complete system with a safety factor of two or more	☐	☐	☐	
22	Vertical lifelines Ref. 1910.140(c)(3)	One employee per vertical lifeline	☐	☐	☐	
23	Horizontal lifeline supervision Ref. 1910.140(c)(11)(i)	Designed, installed and used under the supervision of a qualified person	☐	☐	☐	
24	Horizontal lifeline that may become vertical Ref. 1910.140(d)(2)(i)	Connecting device locks in both directions on the lifeline	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION D | Fit, rigging and rescue

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
25	Attachment point Ref. 1910.140(c)(22)	Harness attachment point in the center of the back near shoulder level; chest point only where free fall is 2 feet (0.6 m) or less	☐	☐	☐	
26	Free fall and clearance Ref. 1910.140(d)(2)(ii)	Rigged so the worker cannot free fall more than 6 feet (1.8 m) or contact a lower level, unless the manufacturer exception in the clause is demonstrated	☐	☐	☐	

General guidance only, not legal advice. Check the current regulation and your employer's procedures.

SECTION D | Fit, rigging and rescue

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
27	Neck and chin Ref. 1910.140(d)(1)(iv)	Strap configuration would hold the worker without contacting the neck and chin area	☐	☐	☐	
28	Rescue Ref. 1910.140(c)(21)	Arrangements for prompt rescue of each employee after a fall are in place for this job	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION E | Window cleaners' positioning systems

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
29	Window anchor condition Ref. 1910.140(e)(2)(v)	Anchors with damaged or deteriorated fastenings or supports are removed, or their heads detached so they cannot be used	☐	☐	☐	
30	Window anchor height Ref. 1910.140(e)(2)(ii)	Anchor in the side frame or mullion, 42 to 51 inches (106.7 to 129.5 cm) above the sill	☐	☐	☐	
31	Rope condition Ref. 1910.140(e)(2)(vi)	No rope in use with wear or deterioration that affects its strength	☐	☐	☐	
32	Both terminals attached Ref. 1910.140(e)(2)(vii)	Each belt terminal on a separate window anchor during cleaning	☐	☐	☐	
33	Attachment before climbing out Ref. 1910.140(e)(2)(x)	At least one terminal attached before the worker climbs through the opening and until fully back inside	☐	☐	☐	
34	Sill or ledge surface Ref. 1910.140(e)(2)(viii)	No snow, ice or other slippery condition; not weakened or rotted	☐	☐	☐	
35	Sill or ledge width and slope Ref. 1910.140(e)(2)(ix)(A)	At least 4 inches (10 cm) wide and sloping no more than 15 degrees below horizontal (steeper sills: see 1910.140(e)(2)(ix)(B))	☐	☐	☐	

DEFECTS FOUND AND ACTION TAKEN

Item no.	Defect description	Reported to	Action taken / date closed

SIGN-OFF

SAFE TO OPERATE? ☐ Yes ☐ No: tagged out of service

INSPECTOR SIGNATURE	DATE / TIME
SUPERVISOR REVIEW	DATE / TIME